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Thread, string, yarn

1.5.3.1 Thread, string, yarn

References:

Hebrew חוּט (chut) GEN 14:23, JOS 2:18, JDG 16:12, ECC 4:12, SNG 4:3

Hebrew פְּתִיל (pathil) GEN 38:18, GEN 38:25, EXO 28:28, EXO 28:37, EXO 39:3, EXO 39:21, EXO 39:31, NUM 15:38, NUM 19:15, JDG 16:9, EZK 40:3

Description:

A piece of string (Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)Thread or yarn for weaving was made by twisting fibers on a spindle (see 1.5.3 Cloth manufacture<REALIA:1.5.3>). A single strand of thread made in this way was not particularly strong, but cloth made by interweaving many of these thin strands together was strong enough for many uses. See also 1.14 Rope, cord<REALIA:1.14>.

Translation:

The essential difference between “thread” or “string” and “cord” or “rope” was less in its thickness than in its composition. A rope or cord was made of two or more single strands twisted or braided together. All the occurrences of the Hebrew word *pathil* are listed here, but in one or two of the passages the translator may consider that a heavier cord is intended.

In EXO 39:3 the Hebrew word *pathil* is used to refer to fine “threads” (RSV, CEV) or “strands” (NIV) made of gold. Some languages may have a separate word for such a “filament” made of metal.